DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 7

Microsoft Power BI specialist

Profession 7 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A Power BI specialist builds data models, measures, dashboards and secure sharing for organisations using Microsoft Power BI.

What professionals do every day

Connects to data sources, shapes data in Power Query, builds the model and DAX measures, designs reports, sets row-level security and publishes to the service.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Organisations need self-service dashboards that refresh and stay secure. A specialist builds the model that makes the reports fast and correct.

- Slow reports caused by a poor model.
- Measures that give different totals in different reports.
- Access that is too broad.

Skills you need

- Power Query.
- Data modelling and relationships.
- DAX measures and time intelligence.
- Row-level security and publishing.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Power BI Desktop	Dashboards	Free	Power BI Pro and Premium plans (verify)	powerbi.microsoft.com/desktop/
Microsoft Learn: Power BI	Official learning	Free	Free	learn.microsoft.com/power-bi/
Microsoft Excel	Analysis and reports	Free online version	Microsoft 365 plans	www.microsoft.com/microsoft-365/excel

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Import and clean one table in Power Query.
Intermediate	Build a star schema with two dimension tables.
Advanced	Write five measures and test each total.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Executive dashboard for a firm.
- **Intermediate:** Sales model for a chain of shops.
- **Advanced:** Finance summary with security by region.

Client-ready portfolio project

A Power BI executive dashboard (see Module D for the measures) for a fictional firm, with a model diagram, measures, row-level security test and publishing notes.

Worked example

Worked example. Total revenue is defined once as a measure and reused in every visual, so every report shows the same total.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Single definition of revenue

Business problem: Two reports show different revenue totals.

Steps

1. Find where each report calculates revenue.
2. Replace both with one shared measure.
3. Check the totals match on the same filter.
4. Write the definition in the model's description.

Expected output: The shared measure and a matching total.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

One measure, one definition. Check the totals on the same filter before and after to prove the change. The DAX pattern is in Module D; test it in Power BI Desktop.

Common mistakes

- Calculated columns used where measures are needed.
- Many-to-many relationships without a plan.
- Sharing reports without row-level security.
- No refresh schedule.

Freelancing opportunities

- Power BI builds and maintenance for small firms.
- Dashboard training for client teams.
- Briefs for 'Power BI', 'DAX', 'dashboard'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- Microsoft Power BI documentation

Part of **Master Freelancing: Data Analytics and Data Science**. Back to the chapter list on skillnavora.in · Open the full textbook. Official links in this chapter were not checked live; confirm before relying on them.